

FAB4 Does Europe - September 2026

10 - 29 September 2026



Flight Summary

Date	Flight	Terminal	Airline	Route	Depart → Arrive	Cabin	Duration
Thu 10 Sept	QF162	T1 → T1	Qantas	Wellington (WLG) → Sydney (SYD)	6:05am → 7:45am	Business	3h 40m
Thu 10 Sept	QF1	T1 → T1	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Singapore (SIN)	2:45pm → 9:15pm	Premium Economy	8h 30m
Thu 10 - Fri 11 Sept	BA12	T1 → T5	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	11:20/11:25pm → 6:35am +1	Premium Economy	~14h 10-15m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Business	2h 35m
Fri 11 Sept	BA548	T5 → T3	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Rome Fiumicino (FCO)	8:00am → 11:35am	Economy	2h 35m
Thu 24 Sept	BA575	n/a → T5	British Airways	Milan Linate (LIN) → London Heathrow (LHR)	3:55pm → 4:50pm	Business	1h 55m
Sun 27 - Mon 28 Sept	BA15	T5 → T1	British Airways	London Heathrow (LHR) → Singapore (SIN)	10:00pm → 6:40pm +1	Premium Economy	13h 40m
Mon 28 - Tue 29 Sept	BA15	T1 → T1	British Airways	Singapore (SIN) → Sydney (SYD)	8:20pm → 6:05am +1	Premium Economy	7h 45m
Tue 29 Sept	QF161	T1 → n/a	Qantas	Sydney (SYD) → Wellington (WLG)	9:35am → 3:45pm	Economy	3h 10m

☐ Karen & Gary only
 ☐ Debbie & Tom only
 ☐ All 4 together

All flights are on 2026 dates, operated by Qantas (QF) and British Airways (BA). Reservation codes: Gary & Karen - KXFECY / EKNMYW; Debbie & Tom - UWBGQP / EKH3PP (the Akhursts join the group in Sydney, so have no Wellington-Sydney sector). Frequent flyer numbers, seat assignments and check-in requirements are held in the original Sabre itinerary emails.

Trip at a Glance

Thu 10 Sep (Day 1)	Air travel CONFIRMED Gary & Karen: QF162 (Qantas) Wgtn (WLG) to Syd (T1), arrive 7.45am - FAB4: QF1 (Qantas) Syd (T1) to Singapore (T1), depart 2.45pm, PE SIN transit ~2hrs (T1) - BA12 SIN (T1) to LHR (T5) arrive 6.35am, then BA548 LHR (T5) to FCO (T3) depart 8.00am (both British Airways) - Business Gary & Karen / Economy Debbie & Tom	✈
Fri 11 Sep (Day 2)	Arrival in Rome UNCONFIRMED	☐☐
Sat 12 Sep (Day 3)	Rome UNCONFIRMED Pristine Sistine Early Morning Small Group Tour	☐☐
Sun 13 Sep (Day 4)	Rome UNCONFIRMED Colosseum Areana Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace	☐☐
Mon 14 Sep (Day 5)	Rome UNCONFIRMED Transfer by Private Minibus to Queen Victoria	☐☐
Tue 15 Sep (Day 6)	Sea Day	☐☐
Wed 16 Sep (Day 7)	Marseille France CONFIRMED Marseille and the little train (booked)	☐☐
Thu 17 Sep (Day 8)	Villefranche, France CONFIRMED Monaco Old Town & Scenic Drive (booked)	☐☐
Fri 18 Sep (Day 9)	Genoa, Italy CONFIRMED Discover Genoa (booked)	☐☐
Sat 19 Sep (Day 10)	La Spezia (Florence or Pisa) CONFIRMED Easy Pisa (booked)	☐☐
Sun 20 Sep (Day 11)	Sea Day	☐☐
Mon 21 Sep (Day 12)	Tuscany UNCONFIRMED	☐☐
Tue 22 Sep (Day 13)	Tuscany UNCONFIRMED	☐☐
Wed 23 Sep (Day 14)	Milan UNCONFIRMED	☐☐
Thu 24 Sep (Day 15)	London UNCONFIRMED Dinner at The Lighterman confirmed (4NJL3Z4M6XN3) BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5), Depart 3.55pm arrive 4.50pm, Business, all 4	☐☐
Fri 25 Sep (Day 16)	London CONFIRMED The Mousetrap (confirmed), Dinner at Albert Schloss confirmed	☐☐
Sat 26 Sep (Day 17)	London UNCONFIRMED Tower / Bridge Tour then Six show and then dinner	☐☐
Sun 27 Sep (Day 18)	Air Travel - Depart LHR (T5) 10.00pm UNCONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) London Heathrow (T5) to Singapore (SIN T1), Premium Economy, all 4 NZ Daylight Saving starts here	✈
Mon 28 Sep (Day 19)	Air Travel - Arrive SIN (T1) 6.40pm - Depart 8.20pm CONFIRMED BA15 (British Airways) Singapore (SIN T1) to Sydney (SYD T1), Premium Economy, all 4	✈
Tue 29 Sep (Day 20)	HOME CONFIRMED FAB4 Arrive SYD (T1) 6.05am (Karen and Gary depart SYD (T1) 9.35am on QF161 (Qantas), Economy, arrive WGTN 3.45pm	✈

Rome

11 – 14 September · The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

-
- 11:30 AM** **Arrive Fiumicino Airport (FCO Terminal 3) 11.35am - flight BA548 (British Airways) from London Heathrow (T5)**
-
- 12:00 PM** **Transfer by private minibus - airport to The Republic Hotel (~30-45 min drive depending on traffic, ~28 min best case)**
Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome
[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)
-
- 12:30 PM** **Check in at The Republic Hotel, freshen up**
[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)
-
- 1:00 PM** **Piazza della Repubblica & Fontana delle Naiadi**
Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel
[///mouth.dished.cheaply](https://mouth.dished.cheaply)
-
- 1:30 PM** **Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri (built into the ancient Baths of Diocletian, free entry)**
Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~5 min walk from hotel
[///mouth.dished.cheaply](https://mouth.dished.cheaply)
-
- 2:00 PM** **Free time / coffee near the hotel**
-
- 2:30 PM** **Travel to Villa Borghese Gardens (~20 min by taxi or metro)**
-
- 3:00 PM - 5pm** **Villa Borghese Gardens**
Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy
-
- 5:00 PM - 6:15pm** **Pre-dinner drinks - Terrazza Montemartini (rooftop bar, Palazzo Montemartini) Visit Website: Palazzo Montemartini**
Largo Giovanni Montemartini, Rome - ~10 min walk from hotel
[Website](#)
-
- 6:30 PM** **Dinner - pick from the suggestions below**
-

Dinner Suggestions (8 ideas, within ~20 min walk of the hotel)

Trimani Il Winebar

Rome's original wine bar (est. 1821 as a wine merchant) - simple Roman menu, huge wine list, fair prices

Via Cernaia 37 - ~3 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 11:30am-3pm & 5:30pm-midnight (closed Sun)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

☐ *Trimani started life in 1821 as a family wine merchant business - it's still run by the same Trimani family six generations later, and was the first place in the world to actually call itself a "Wine Bar".*

Rifugio Romano

Cosy trattoria a couple of minutes from Termini - classic Roman pastas, friendly service

Via Volturno 12 - ~6 min walk

☐ **Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Osteria Quarantaquattro

Relaxed osteria near Piazza della Repubblica - Roman staples, good value set menus

Via Volturno area - ~6 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Pizzeria Ristoro Est! Est!! Est!!!

Rome's oldest pizzeria (since 1905) - thin-crust Roman-style pizza, great old-school atmosphere

Via Genova 32 - ~8 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - typically lunch & dinner daily**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

☐ *The odd name comes from a medieval legend: a bishop travelling to Rome sent his servant ahead to chalk "Est!" (Latin for "it is [good]") on the doors of inns with good wine. At Montefiascone the wine was so good the servant wrote "Est! Est!! Est!!!" three times - the bishop loved it so much he settled there for the rest of his life.*

Osteria Barberini

Cosy osteria near Piazza Barberini - known for truffle dishes and classic Roman cuisine

Via della Purificazione 21 - ~17 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria dell'Omo

Probably the closest proper trattoria to Termini - traditional Roman menu that changes by the day (gnocchi on Thursdays)

Via Vicenza 18 - ~5 min walk

☐ **Daily 12pm-3pm & 7pm-10:45pm**

[Reviews](#)

La Matriciana dal 1870

Rome institution since 1870 opposite the Opera House - the amatriciana it's named after, plus classic carbonara

Via del Viminale 44 - ~10 min walk

☐ **Sun-Fri 12:15-3pm & 7:15-11pm (closed Sat)**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Monti

Long-running family trattoria near Piazza Vittorio serving Le Marche regional dishes - olive ascolane, tortello al rosso d'uovo. Book ahead, it's popular

Via di San Vito 13 - ~12 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - reservations recommended**

[Reviews](#)

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 - therepublic@aghotels.it)**

5:30 AM

Early breakfast at The Republic Hotel (confirm 5:30am service with hotel in advance - standard buffet runs 7:00-10:30am) [TO CONFIRM](#)

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](#)

7:00 AM -
11:15am

Pristine Sistine Early Morning Small Group Tour - entry 7:15am (4hrs)

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel, Vatican City Visit Website: Walks of Italy

[Website](#) [I](#)

12:00 PM

Lunch at Target Restaurant [OPTIONAL](#)

Near Piazza della Repubblica, Rome - ~8 min walk from hotel Visit Website: Ristorante Target

[Website](#)

1:00 PM

Free afternoon in Rome - pick from the 6 suggestions below

Saturday Afternoon Suggestions (6 ideas, after lunch)

Trevi Fountain [///wiped.school.dreaming](#)

Iconic baroque fountain - toss a coin in for luck (~15 min walk from hotel)

Piazza di Trevi, Rome

Spanish Steps & Piazza di Spagna [///rungs.diverts.tractor](#)

Famous steps, great people-watching and shopping nearby (~20 min walk)

Piazza di Spagna, Rome

Pantheon [///strictly.into.evokes](#)

Best-preserved ancient Roman building, free entry (~20-25 min walk)

Piazza della Rotonda, Rome

Piazza Navona [///drank.navy.scanning](#)

Grand baroque square with Bernini's Fountain of the Four Rivers, lively cafes (~25-30 min walk or short taxi)

Piazza Navona, Rome

Galleria Borghese

///detained.planting.describe

World-class Bernini/Caravaggio art collection - needs a pre-booked timed entry ticket, so only if booked in advance

Piazzale Scipione Borghese 5, Rome

Website

Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter

///searched.circling.supposed

Guided tour through the ancient necropolis beneath St Peter's Basilica, ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance, no photos allowed, small groups only

Meet at the Ufficio Scavi (Excavations Office), Piazza San Pietro, Vatican City

Website

Reviews

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats from the 11th)

Ai Tre Scalini - Bottiglieria dal 1895

Historic Monti wine bar (since 1895) - great wines by the glass, traditional small plates, lively atmosphere

Via Panisperna 251, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ Daily 12pm-10pm

Reviews

☐ The name means "at the three steps" - a nod to the three little steps down into its cosy, cellar-like wine bar, which has barely changed since it opened in 1895.

La Carbonara

Rome institution since 1906, famous for its namesake dish - carbonara, amatriciana, cacio e pepe

Via Panisperna 214, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ Mon-Sat 12:30-2:30pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)

Reviews

☐ Ironically, this restaurant opened in 1906 - decades before food historians think the dish carbonara was even invented (most trace it to Rome in the 1940s, possibly influenced by American GI rations of eggs and bacon).

Al Vino al Vino

Intimate Monti enoteca (since 1999) - excellent wine list by the glass, sweet-and-sour eggplant caponata

Via dei Serpenti 19, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Thu & Sun 7pm-midnight, Fri-Sat 7pm-1:30am**

Reviews

La Taverna dei Monti

Popular traditional trattoria - carbonara, cacio e pepe and other Roman staples done well

Via del Boschetto 41, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Tue-Sun 12:30pm-11pm (closed Mon)**

Reviews

Alle Carrette

One of the best-loved pizzerias in Monti - good prices, lovely courtyard seating out back

Vicolo delle Carrette, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - published hours conflict between sources**

Reviews

Maharajah

Well-rated Indian restaurant in the middle of Monti - good change of pace if craving something other than Italian

Via dei Serpenti 124, Monti - ~14 min walk

☐ **Mon-Thu 12:30-3pm & 7:30pm-midnight (check ahead for weekends)**

Website

Reviews

Temakinho

Fun Brazilian-Japanese fusion (sushi meets caipirinha) - colourful spot a few steps from the Colosseum end of Monti

Via dei Serpenti 16, Monti - ~13 min walk

☐ **Daily 12-3:30pm & 7-11:30pm**

[Website](#)[Reviews](#)

Taverna Romana

Popular family-run local spot known for authentic Roman cuisine and reasonable prices - book ahead as it fills fast

Via della Madonna dei Monti 79, Monti - ~14 min walk

🕒 **Mon-Sat 12-3pm & 7:30-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

📍 **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 · therepublic@aghotels.it)**

8:00 AM

Breakfast at The Republic Hotel (included, buffet 7:00-10:30am)

The Republic Hotel, Via Gaeta 61, Rome

[///sports.pocket.anchors](https://sports.pocket.anchors)

9:00 AM

Self-guided morning walk - Roman Forum viewpoint, Trajan's Column & Markets, Piazza del Campidoglio (all free, ~10 min walk to Piazza del Colosseo afterwards)

Via dei Fori Imperiali, Rome

1:00 PM

Lunch near Piazza del Colosseo - pick from the 5 suggestions below

3:30 PM - 7:00pm

Colosseum Arena Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace Tour - meet 3:30pm (3.5hrs)

Piazza del Colosseo, 1, 00184 Roma RM, Italy Visit Website: Walks of Italy

[///food.reddish.dormant](https://food.reddish.dormant)

[Website](#)



Lunch Suggestions Near Piazza del Colosseo (8 ideas, before the tour)

Il Salotto del Colosseo

TripAdvisor 4.7★ - "great lunch by the Colosseum", cosy hidden gem

Via di S. Giovanni in Laterano 42, Rome - ~2 min from Piazza del Colosseo

☐ Daily 11am-11:30pm

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Fuorinorma

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - "best panini in Rome", fresh charcuterie boards, quick and casual

Via dei Serpenti 178, Monti - ~10 min walk to Colosseo

☐ Mon-Sat 11:30am-11:30pm (closed Sun)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Luzzi

Bustling local trattoria/pizzeria, a few blocks from the Colosseum - good value, always busy

Via di San Giovanni in Laterano 88, Rome

☐ **Mon, Tue, Thu-Sun 12pm-midnight (closed Wed)**

Coming Out

TripAdvisor 4.6★ - relaxed all-day cafe/bar right by the Colosseum, big varied menu

Via San Giovanni in Laterano 8, Rome

☐ **Check ahead - known for long/late hours but not consistently published**

Le Naumachie (Naumachia)

Long-running Roman/Tuscan institution near the Colosseum, grilled mains

Via Celimontana 7, Rome

☐ **Daily 11am-11:30pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Cafè Cafè

Relaxed bistro/wine bar near the Colosseum - smoothies, salads and sandwiches, good for a lighter lunch

Via dei Santi Quattro 44, Rome

☐ **Mon & Wed-Sun 9:30am-7:45pm, Tue 9:30am-4:15pm**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Terre e Domus

Enoteca run by the Province of Rome next to Trajan's Column - ingredients sourced entirely from the Lazio region

Foro Traiano 82, Rome

☐ **Daily 9am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

La Taverna dei Quaranta

Family-run local trattoria near the Colosseum, serving since 1984 - authentic Roman classics

Via Claudia 24, Rome

☐ **Mon-Wed 12-3:30pm & 7:30pm-midnight**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

8 More Dinner Suggestions (no repeats - handy for after the Colosseum tour)

Hostaria al Boschetto

Warm, cosy Roman comfort food - a Monti favourite, fair prices

Via del Boschetto, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Reviews](#)

Urbana 47

Farm-to-table Italian - seasonal, organic produce with a modern twist on Roman classics

Via Urbana 47, Monti - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 8:30am-midnight**

[Website](#)

La Bottega del Caffè

Lively bar/trattoria right on the prettiest square in Monti - good for a relaxed evening

Piazza Madonna dei Monti 5, Monti - ~16 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-2am, Sun 9am-2am**

[Reviews](#)

Ornelli Black Angus Steakhouse

TripAdvisor 4.8★ - top-rated steakhouse, handy since it's right near where today's Colosseum tour finishes

Via Merulana 224 - ~20 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Closed Mondays - check ahead for exact times**

[Reviews](#)

Cuoco & Camicia

TripAdvisor 4.5★ - relaxed elegance, modern Italian cuisine, near the Colosseum end of the tour

Near Cavour/Colosseum - ~22 min walk from hotel, ~5 min from the Colosseum

☐ **Check ahead - hours not consistently published**

[Website](#)

[Reviews](#)

Trattoria Vecchia Roma

Traveller's Choice 2025 winner, est. 1916 - famous for its Amatriciana Flambé, near Piazza Vittorio

Via Ferruccio 12B/C, Esquilino - ~18 min walk

☐ **Mon-Sat 12:30-3pm & 7-11pm (closed Sun)**

[Reviews](#)

Le Caveau

Traveller's Choice-rated Italian restaurant near Piazza Vittorio - fried baby octopus, burrata, good all-rounder

Via Conte Verde 6, Esquilino - ~15 min walk

☐ **Daily 12pm-11pm**

[Reviews](#)

Hostaria Al Gladiatore

Over 200 years serving Roman classics right on Piazza del Colosseo - come for the Colosseum view as much as the carbonara

Piazza del Colosseo 5 - ~20 min walk from hotel, on the Colosseum square

☐ **Daily 7am-midnight**

[Reviews](#)

☐ **Staying at The Republic Hotel, Rome - Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome (+39 06 8115 7001 - therepublic@aghotels.it)**

Things to Consider - Rome / Cruise

Day	Item	Status	Notes
Tuscany	Coffee/breakfast stop - Il Caffè degli Amici	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.7/5 (562 reviews). Via Roma 121, ~5 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.
Tuscany	Pastries/coffee stop - Pasticceria La Golosa	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.4/5 (31 reviews). Via Palazzuolo, ~7 min walk from Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais. See Italy Map tab.

Sat (12)	Plan Saturday afternoon in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free from ~11:15am after the Sistine Chapel tour
Sun (13)	Plan Sunday morning in Rome TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Free until the 3:30pm Colosseum tour
Mon (14)	Confirm transfer time to Queen Victoria TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Likely mid-afternoon - what to do in Rome first thing that morning?
Wed (16)	Land excursion - Marseille, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Thu (17)	Land excursion - Villefranche, France	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Fri (18)	Land excursion - Genoa, Italy	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Sat (19)	Land excursion - La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)	BOOKED	Queen Victoria shore day
Rome	Choose restaurant for Veal Scaloppine al limone dinner TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Options on Rome Map tab: Cantina Cantarini da Mario, Girarrosto Fiorentino, Colline Emiliane, Trattoria Monti
Tuscany	Dinner option - Ristorante Triocco	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.6/5 (334 reviews), #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa. Via Vittorio Veneto 48, ~5 km / short drive from hotel (in Barberino Val d'Elsa, not walking distance). See Tuscany Map tab.
Tuscany	Lunch option (en route, 21 Sep) - Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone	OPTIONAL	Tripadvisor 4.0/5 (832 reviews), #1 of 19 restaurants in Talamone. Strada Vicinale delle Casacce 65, Talamone - stop along the Civitavecchia to Tuscany drive route. See Tuscany Map tab.

Queen Victoria Cruise

14 – 20 September · Marseille · Villefranche · Genoa · La Spezia

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.



2:00 PM **Transfer by private minibus to Queen Victoria - evening departure** **TO CONFIRM**

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

[///snipe.nipped.miss](http://snipe.nipped.miss)**6:00 PM** **Board Queen Victoria - depart Rome (Civitavecchia)**

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

7:00 PM **Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)****BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website**8:00 PM** **Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM **Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club****OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

 **Staying aboard Queen Victoria (departs Rome)**

9:00 AM

Sea Day

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM

Drinking Gin

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Rhubarb Gin review: smooth, floral, dangerously easy to drink (9/10) OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



Staying aboard Queen Victoria

8:00 AM In port: Marseille, France

Marseille, France

9:00 AM Marseille and the Little Train

BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website



5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club - Gary's Pepsi Max review: does exactly what a Pepsi Max should do, zero surprises (7/10)

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



📌 **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

8:00 AM In port: Villefranche, France

Villefranche, France

9:00 AM Monaco and the Old Town **BOOKED**

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website **I****5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)**BOOKED**

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website **I****8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre** **OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club**OPTIONAL**

Aboard Queen Victoria

I**☐ Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

8:00 AM In port: Genoa, Italy

Genoa, Italy

9:00 AM Discover Genoa shore excursion

BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

Website



5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



10:00 PM Churchill's Cigar Lounge, Level 10

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria, Level 10 (Commodore Deck)

Staying aboard Queen Victoria

8:00 AM In port: La Spezia (Florence or Pisa)

La Spezia, Italy

9:00 AM Easy Pisa - 7.45am tour BOOKED

Visit Website: Cunard Shore Excursions

[Website](#) I

5:00 PM Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

[Website](#) I

8:00 PM Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

I

I **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

9:00 AM

Sea Day

Aboard Queen Victoria

4:00 PM

Drinking Gin

Aboard Queen Victoria

5:00 PM

Pre-dinner drinks at the Golden Lion Pub

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

6:00 PM

Dinner at Britannia Restaurant (confirmed for all 4)

BOOKED

Visit Website: Queen Victoria

Website



8:00 PM

Evening Show, Royal Court Theatre

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria

9:30 PM

Rhubarb Gin & Pepsi Max at the Commodore Club

OPTIONAL

Aboard Queen Victoria



📌 **Staying aboard Queen Victoria**

Cunard Voyage Info (V618D)

Day	Port	Arrives	Departs
Mon 14 Sep	Civitavecchia (depart Rome)	–	Evening
Tue 15 Sep	At Sea	–	–
Wed 16 Sep	Marseille, France	Early morning	Evening
Thu 17 Sep	Villefranche, France	Early morning	Evening
Fri 18 Sep	Genoa, Italy	Early morning	Late evening
Sat 19 Sep	La Spezia (tours to Florence or Pisa)	Early morning	Evening
Sun 20 Sep	At Sea	–	–

Ship Stats

Guests	Crew	Length
2,059	913	964.5 ft

Onboard - Things to Check Out

Venue	Notes
Gala evenings	Formal nights with themed menus, cocktails, decorations, music and dancing
Princess Grill Restaurant	Reserved table each night, elevated menu, sea views
Chart Room	Signature venue with zodiac-themed cocktails, dark woods, golden lighting
Queens Room	Fencing classes, Afternoon Tea, live music, dancing
Grill Suites Terrace/ Courtyard	Outdoor sanctuary for Queens/Princess Grill Suite guests, sun loungers, drinks service
Gym	Included in fare, guests 16+, sea views, optional fitness classes/ personal training
Children's clubs	Under-18s, book via the My Voyage portal on board – games, arts and crafts, activities

Full deck plan: [View Deck Plan \(PDF\)](#)

Tuscany

21 – 22 September · Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

9:00 AM

Collect Avis hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Civitavecchia Downtown, Via 16 Settembre 46, Cruise Ship Gate

///snipe.nipped.miss

9:30 AM

Drive from Civitavecchia to Talamone (approx. 2h)

Directions: Civitavecchia to Talamone

[Directions](#)

11:30 AM

Lunch option: Agriturismo Buratta, TalamoneOPTIONAL

Directions: Agriturismo Buratta

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Directions](#)

1:00 PM

Drive from Talamone to Tuscany hotel (approx. 2h)

Directions: Talamone to Tuscany

[Directions](#)

3:00 PM

Arrive Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa Parking note: free onsite parking (contact hotel in advance to reserve a space)

📍 **Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)**

9:00 AM

Potential Breakfast/Coffee: Il Caffè degli Amici

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Il Caffè degli Amici

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Directions](#)

[I](#)

4:00 PM

Potential Pastries/Coffee: Pasticceria La Golosa

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Pasticceria La Golosa

[Website](#)

[Directions](#)

7:00 PM

Potential Restaurant: Triocco

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Triocco

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Directions](#)

[I](#)

📍 **Staying at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais, Tuscany - Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa (+39 055 807 3333 · info@borgodicortefreda.com)**

Mercedes Drive Times - Monday 21 September

Leg	Approx. Distance	Approx. Drive Time	Notes
Civitavecchia (car collection) → Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone	~140 km	~2h 00m	Coastal route via SS1 Aurelia
Agriturismo Buratta, Talamone → Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais	~140 km	~2h 00m	Via SS223 (Siena-Grosseto), then north toward Tavarnelle
Total driving, via Talamone lunch stop	~280 km	~4h 00m driving (excl. lunch)	Direct route without the detour is approx. 230 km / 3h 10m

Estimates only – not a live routing query. Confirm via GPS/Google Maps on the day; actual times will vary with traffic and any stops.

Milan

23 September · iQ Hotel Milano

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

9:00 AM -
12:10pm

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Milan (approx. 3h 10m)

Directions: Tuscany to Milan

[Directions](#)

12:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#) [I](#)

1:00 PM -
6:00pm

Free time / sightseeing in Milan (Duomo, Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II, Navigli) [TO CONFIRM](#)

Milan city centre

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan [TO BOOK](#)

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar [BOOKED](#)

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#) [Menu](#)

Alternative Options for 23 September

Four alternative full-day plans in place of the base Tuscany → Milan drive above - pick one.

Note on Option C: Venice is a significant detour east before doubling back west to Milan - approx. 610 km / ~6h 20m total driving (vs. ~1h 30m for the base plan, ~5h 15m for Option A, ~3h 40m for Option B, ~5h 25m for Option D). Also note Venice's historic centre is car-free, so the car must be left at Tronchetto or Piazzale Roma and the centre reached on foot/vaporetto. Worth confirming everyone's comfortable with the long day before booking.

Note on Option D: Combines Pisa (Leaning Tower climb, pre-booked skip-the-line small-group tour recommended - tours run at multiple times throughout the day, book ahead for the 23rd) with a Lake Como lunch stop en route to Milan. It's a long day (~5h

25m total driving, on top of ~1h 30m at Pisa) but covers two bucket-list stops in one go.

OPTION A - LAKE COMO, LUNCH AT HARRY'S (23 SEP) [Total driving: 5h 15m]

6:00 AM -
7:00 AM

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Bologna (approx. 1h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Bologna

[Directions](#)

7:30 AM -
8:30am

Arrive Bologna - Breakfast at Aroma Specialty Coffee

OPTIONAL

Via Portanova 12/b, 40123 Bologna, Italy Visit Website: Aroma Specialty Coffee (Il Piacere del Caffè)

[Website](#) [I](#)

8:30 AM -
11:00am

Drive from Bologna to Como (approx. 2h 30m)

Directions: Bologna to Como

[Directions](#)

11:00 AM

Arrive Como - Como-Brunate Funicular up to Brunate (approx. 7 min ride)

Piazza Alcide de Gasperi 4, 22100 Como, Italy Visit Website: Funicolare Como-Brunate

[Website](#)

11:30 AM -
12:30pm

Gelato with a view at Il Balcone sul Lago Café, Brunate

OPTIONAL

Via Pissarottino 26, 22034 Brunate (Como), Italy Visit Website: Il Balcone sul Lago (Facebook)

[Website](#)

12:30 PM

Drive from Como to Cernobbio (approx. 15 min)

Directions: Como to Cernobbio

[Directions](#)

1:00 PM -
2:30pm

Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio (Lake Como)

OPTIONAL

Via Besana 1, 22012 Cernobbio, Como, Italy Visit Website: Harry's Bar Cernobbio

[Website](#) [Menu](#) [I](#)

2:30 PM -
3:30pm

Drive from Lake Como to Milan (approx. 1h)

Directions: Lake Como to Milan

Directions

3:30 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)

[I](#)

**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan [TO BOOK](#)

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar [BOOKED](#)

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION A) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

OPTION B - FERRARI MUSEUM, MARANELLO (23 SEP) [Total driving: 3h 40m]

9:00 AM -
10:40am

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Maranello (approx. 1h 40m)

Directions: Tuscany to Maranello

[Directions](#)

11:00 AM -
1:00pm

Visit Museo Ferrari, Maranello OPTIONAL

Via Dino Ferrari 43, 41053 Maranello (MO), Italy Visit Website: Museo Ferrari

[Website](#) [I](#)

1:00 PM -
2:00pm

Lunch near Ferrari Museum, Maranello OPTIONAL

2:00 PM -
4:00pm

Drive from Maranello to Milan (approx. 2h)

Directions: Maranello to Milan

[Directions](#)

4:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#) [I](#)

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano) Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#) [Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION B) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan (+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)**

OPTION C - VENICE LUNCH (23 SEP) [Total driving: 6h 20m]

6:00 AM -
9:30am

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Venice (approx. 3h 30m)

Directions: Tuscany to Venice

[Directions](#)

9:30 AM

Arrive Venice - park at Tronchetto/Piazzale Roma (historic centre is car-free)

Tronchetto Parking, Isola del Tronchetto, 30135 Venice, Italy

[Website](#)

[Directions](#)

[I](#)

10:00 AM -
12:30pm

Free time - explore St Mark's Square & Rialto Bridge

OPTIONAL

12:30 PM -
2:00pm

Lunch in Venice

TO BOOK

[Website](#)

2:00 PM -
4:50pm

Drive from Venice to Milan (approx. 2h 50m)

Directions: Venice to Milan

[Directions](#)

5:00 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)

[I](#)

7:00 PM -
8:30pm

Dinner in Milan

TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

9:00 PM -
10:00pm

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar

BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)
Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION C) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

OPTION D - PISA & LEANING TOWER, LAKE COMO (23 SEP) [Total driving: approx. 5h 25m]

**6:00 AM -
7:15am**

Check out of Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais & drive to Pisa (approx. 1h 15m)

Directions: Tuscany to Pisa

[Directions](#)

7:30 AM

Arrive Pisa - coffee near Piazza dei Miracoli OPTIONAL

Piazza dei Miracoli, Pisa, Italy

**8:00 AM -
9:30am**

Skip-the-line Leaning Tower of Pisa - guided small-group tour (approx. 1h 30m, incl. tower climb) TO BOOK

Meeting point: P.za Daniele Manin 6, Pisa (near Porta Nuova gate) Visit Website: Viator - Pisa Skip-the-Line Tower Tour

[Website](#)

9:30 AM

Free time / photos at Piazza dei Miracoli OPTIONAL

**10:00 AM -
1:10pm**

Drive from Pisa to Como (approx. 3h 10m)

Directions: Pisa to Como

[Directions](#)

**1:00 PM -
2:30pm**

Lunch at Harry's Bar, Cernobbio (Lake Como) OPTIONAL

Via Besana 1, 22012 Cernobbio, Como, Italy Visit Website: Harry's Bar Cernobbio

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)



**2:30 PM -
3:30pm**

Drive from Lake Como to Milan (approx. 1h)

Directions: Lake Como to Milan

[Directions](#)

3:30 PM

Arrive Milan - Check-in at iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan, Italy Check-in from 3:00pm - call ahead if arriving early: +39 02 8498 0810 Parking note: no private hotel parking - nearest partner garage ~100m away (fee applies, ask reception)

[Website](#)



**7:00 PM -
8:30pm**

Dinner in Milan TO BOOK

Options: Cantine Milano, L'Immagine Bistrot, Casa Festa Alcolica - see Italy Map tab

[Website](#)

**9:00 PM -
10:00pm**

Nightcap drinks at LiQuido Rooftop Bar BOOKED

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy (rooftop of iQ Hotel Milano)

Visit TripAdvisor: LiQuido Rooftop Bar

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

📍 **iQ Hotel Milano, Milan (OPTION D) - Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan**
(+39 02 8498 0810 · info@iqhotelmilano.it)

Potential Dinner Restaurants - Milan (23 September, all 3 plans)

All confirmed open on a Wednesday. The first three (Cantine Milano, L'Immagine, Casa Festa) were the original shortlist; the five below (Osteria Cornalia, Da Gigi, Osteria Nanin - Torriani, Giannino dal 1899, Pizza Shambò) are all 4-5 star Italian/Mediterranean options and much closer to the hotel (6-12 min walk, except Pizza Shambò at ~25 min). Hours and ratings sourced online – please reconfirm nearer the date. Distances are estimates only, from iQ Hotel Milano.

Cantine Milano

Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00pm–12:30am

Via Trau 1, 20159 Milano

□ ~1.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~20 min walk / ~7 min taxi · Walk via Via Sammartini, or short taxi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

L'Immagine Ristorante Bistrot

Open Wed: 6:00–10:30pm (dinner only)

Via Varesina 61, 20156 Milano

□ ~4.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~15 min taxi / ~25 min metro + walk · Taxi, or M5 to Portello then ~10 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Casa Festa - Pizzeria Alcolica

Open Wed: 11:30am–3:00pm & 6:30–11:30pm

Viale Bligny 42, 20136 Milano

□ ~4.8 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~18 min taxi / ~25 min metro · Taxi, or M3 toward Porta Romana/Lodi then ~8 min walk

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Cornalia

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (362 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00pm–12:00am

Via Emilio Cornalia 16, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.6 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~8 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani/Via Sammartini

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Da Gigi Ristorante & Pizzeria

TheFork 8.9/10 · Open Wed: 12:00pm–11:00pm (non-stop)

Via Mauro Macchi 2, 20124 Milano

□ ~0.5 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~7 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani/Via Mauro Macchi

[Website](#)[Menu](#)[Map](#)[I](#)

Osteria Nanin - Torriani

TripAdvisor 4.0★ (97 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–10:45pm

Via Napo Torriani 10, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.45 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~6 min walk · Walk via Via Napo Torriani

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Giannino dal 1899

TripAdvisor 4.3★ (303 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 7:00–11:30pm

Via Vittor Pisani 6, 20124 Milano

📍 ~0.9 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~12 min walk · Walk via Via Vittor Pisani towards Piazza della Repubblica

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

Pizza Shambò

TripAdvisor 4.6★ (229 reviews) · Open Wed: 12:00–3:00pm & 6:00–11:00pm

Via Edolo 1, 20125 Milano

📍 ~2.0 km from iQ Hotel Milano · ~25 min walk / ~10 min taxi · Taxi, or bus/tram towards Via Porpora

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[Map](#)

[I](#)

London

24 – 27 September · The Level at Meliá White House

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Getting Around: Tube Map & Travel Pass

Nearest station to the hotel: Great Portland Street (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) – approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite The Level at Meliá White House.

[CLICK HERE for the Official TfL Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Getting a travel pass for the few days:

Contactless bank card / Apple Pay / Google Pay – simplest option for most visitors. Just tap in and out at the yellow readers on the Tube, buses, DLR, Overground and Elizabeth line – no need to buy anything in advance. Fares are automatically capped at around £8.90/day for Zones 1-2 (2026 rate), so a few days of sightseeing between Zone 1 (central London) and Zone 2 (Regent's Park/Camden area) should never cost more than the daily cap, even if you tap in and out a lot. Check your bank doesn't charge foreign transaction fees before relying on this.

Visitor Oyster card – order online before you fly (from about £5 plus however much credit you preload) or buy a standard Oyster card at any station on arrival (£7 refundable deposit). Works exactly like contactless with the same daily cap, and avoids any card fees or acceptance issues. Top up at station machines or the TfL Oyster app.

7 Day Travelcard – only worth considering if doing lots of travel every single day; for a 4-day stay like this one, pay-as-you-go (contactless or Oyster) with the daily cap works out cheaper and more flexible.

[Order a Visitor Oyster Card](#)

[Current TfL Fares](#)

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

12:00 PM

Return hire car - Mercedes Vito (booking ref NZ759149602) BOOKED

Milan Linate Airport Directions from iQ Hotel Milano

[Directions](#)

2:30 PM

Flight BA575 (British Airways) Milan Linate to London Heathrow (T5) - arrives 2:50pm

Milan Linate (LIN) to London Heathrow (LHR Terminal 5)

3:00 PM

Take the Tube from Heathrow (Terminal 5)

Elizabeth line to Paddington, then Hammersmith & City/Circle line to Great Portland Street (~50 min, approx. £15.50 pp)

4:00 PM

Arrive at The Level at Meliá White House - check in / drop bags

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP

[///baked.belly.neck](http://baked.belly.neck)

4:30 PM -
5:00 PM

Tapas and Gin for Deb

6:30 PM -
7:00 PM

Dinner at The Lighterman (confirmation 4NJL3Z4M6XN3)

BOOKED

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH (~1 mile / 20 min walk from hotel)

☎ 020 3846 3400

[///guides.riots.trader](http://guides.riots.trader)

(If we're early, we could grab a quick Gin & Pepsi downstairs first 😊)

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

[I](#)

After The Lighterman: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

The Parcel Yard

Grade I listed Fuller's pub inside King's Cross station itself

King's Cross Station, London N1 9AL

📍 **From The Lighterman: ~8 min walking**

📍 **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

Big Chill Bar

Three-storey bar/club with a roof terrace, near the station

257-259 Pentonville Rd, London N1 9NL

▮ **From The Lighterman: ~10 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

The Racketeer

Independent, family-run cocktail and wine bar

105 King's Cross Rd, London WC1X 9LR

▮ **From The Lighterman: ~12 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[Menu](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

Spiritland King's Cross

Music-focused listening bar with a serious sound system and a well-executed cocktail list

9-10 Stable St, London N1C 4AB

▮ **From The Lighterman: ~2 min walking**

▮ **To The Melia: ~15 min - Circle/Hammersmith & City/Metropolitan line direct from King's Cross St Pancras to Great Portland Street (2 stops), then ~3 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

▮ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

📍 Sites within 20m

🏪 Shops within 20m

8:00 AM -
8:30 AM

Breakfast at The Level

9:30 AM

Potential Victoria and Albert Museum

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: V&A Museum

///spots.mugs.cards

Directions



12:00 PM

Potential Early Lunch at Harry's Knightsbridge

OPTIONAL

Directions from Hotel: Harry's Knightsbridge

///icon.spends.third

Menu

TripAdvisor

Directions

📄 Harry's Bar-style venues take their name and dolce vita aesthetic from the original Harry's Bar in Venice, opened in 1931 - said to be where the Bellini cocktail and carpaccio were both invented. — [Wikipedia](#)

1:00 PM

Free time wandering around Oxford Street

Oxford Street: [oxfordstreet.co.uk](https://www.oxfordstreet.co.uk)

Website



POTENTIAL SHOPS TO LOOK AT:

Primark

Address

Website

14-28 Oxford Street, London W1D 1AR

Uniqlo

Address

Website

311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP

Selfridges

Address

Website

400 Oxford Street, London W1A 1AB

John Lewis

Address

Website

300 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DX

Hamleys

Address

Website

188-196 Regent Street, London W1B 5BT

Nike Town London

Address

Website

236 Oxford Street, London W1C 1DE

Adidas Flagship Store

Address

Website

425 Oxford Street, London W1C 2PG

Zara Oxford Street

[Address](#)[Website](#)

460-490 Oxford Street, London W1C 1AT

HMV

[Address](#)[Website](#)

363 Oxford Street, London W1C 2LA

Liberty London

[Address](#)[Website](#)

Great Marlborough St / Regent Street, London W1B 5AH

ALSO WORTH A LOOK:

RS No.9 Carnaby (Official Rolling Stones Store)

[///catch.future.librarian](#)

The Rolling Stones' official flagship store - clothing, vinyl and memorabilia, plus a Ronnie Wood art exhibition in the basement (~12 min walk via Regent Street/Carnaby Street)

9 Carnaby St, Carnaby, London W1F 9PE

☐ **Mon-Sat 11am-7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

[Map](#)

**4:30 PM -
5:30 PM**

Dinner at Albert Schloss (booked, ref DMN-16959374828)

[BOOKED](#)

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☐ 020 8165 0000 [///assist.given.desk](#)

[Menu](#)[TripAdvisor](#)[I](#)

☐ *Albert's Schloss is one of a small chain of Alpine-Bavarian bier hall/cabaret venues from The New World Trading Company - the original opened in Manchester in 1917, with the Soho branch spread across several floors of a former Soho building near Piccadilly Circus. — [Albert's Schloss](#)*

6:30 PM

Need to be at Mousetrap by 6:30pm to get in

[BOOKED](#)

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

**7:30 PM -
10pm**

The Mousetrap begins (confirmed ref T071226139201)

[BOOKED](#)

St Martin's Theatre, West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

[///trains.areas.nights](#)

After The Mousetrap: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

Covent Garden Social Club **///begins.jumpy.bake**

Original London Cocktail Club venue, now independent

6-7 Great Newport St, London WC2H 7JB

☐ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~2 min walking**

☐ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Phoenix Artist Club **///meant.costs.defend**

Theatrical cocktail bar and cabaret club beneath the Phoenix Theatre

1 Phoenix St, London WC2H 8BU

☐ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~3 min walking**

☐ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

The Alchemist St Martin's Lane

Theatrical cocktails and post-theatre menu, right around the corner

63-66 St Martin's Ln, London WC2N 4JS

☐ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~4 min walking**

☐ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Leicester Square to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

American Bar at The Savoy

The original 1893 cocktail bar - a London institution, book ahead

The Savoy, Strand, London WC2R 0EU

☐ **From St Martin's Theatre: ~10 min walking**

☐ **To The Melia: ~25 min - Piccadilly line from Covent Garden to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo to Great Portland Street, then ~3 min walk**

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

☐ **Staying at The Level at Melia White House - Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP (+44 20 7391 3000 · melia.white.house@melia.com)**

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

7:30 AM -
8:00 AM**Breakfast at The Level**9:00 AM -
11:00 AM**Combo: Tower of London (Crown Jewels) + Official Tower of London River Tour** **TO CONFIRM**

Tower of London, EC3N 4AB Visit Website: Headout

[///swift.blitz.funds](http://swift.blitz.funds)

Website

TripAdvisor



11:30 AM

To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout (jennifer@inspire.headout.com) **TO CONFIRM**

3:00 PM

Need to be at Vaudeville Theatre by 3:00pm (1hr before show) **BOOKED**

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH

[///diner.donor.rails](http://diner.donor.rails)4:00 PM -
5:15pm**Six the Musical begins - Stalls G8, G9, G10, G11 (4 adults) - see Information tab** **BOOKED**

Vaudeville Theatre, Strand, London WC2R 0NH



❑ *SIX started life as a low-budget student production at Cambridge University in 2017, written by two undergraduates, Toby Marlow and Lucy Moss, who were still in their early twenties. It transferred to the West End in 2019 and has since played on Broadway and around the world. — Wikipedia*

5:30 PM -
6:30pm**Visit Waterstones Piccadilly** **OPTIONAL**

Directions from Hotel: Waterstones Piccadilly

[///blank.buns.bump](http://blank.buns.bump)

Website

Directions



❑ *This shop opened in 1936 as Simpsons of Piccadilly, then Britain's largest menswear store, designed by modernist architect Joseph Emberton. Waterstones took it over in 1999 and it's now Europe's largest bookshop, with over 8 miles of shelving across 6 floors. — Wikipedia*

6:45pm -
8:15pm**Dinner at Hard Rock Cafe London** **TO BOOK**

150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ

[///month.wakes.tests](http://month.wakes.tests)

Website

Menu



After Hard Rock: Nightcap Options

Estimates only – check live transit apps on the day.

4 bars near Hard Rock Cafe:

Rivoli Bar at The Ritz **///jazz.choice.factories**

Art Deco hotel cocktail bar - Ritz signature serves, entered via the main lobby

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

□ **From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking**

□ **To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly/Victoria line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

The Connaught Bar **///tamed.zooms.pest**

World-famous cocktail bar - a Mayfair institution, book ahead

Carlos Pl, Mayfair, London W1K 2AL

□ **From Hard Rock: ~12 min walking**

□ **To The Melia: ~25 min - walk to Bond Street, Central line to Oxford Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

Dukes Bar **///less.candy.award**

Legendary martini bar (since 1908) - birthplace of the 'Vesper' martini style

35 St James's Pl, London SW1A 1NY

□ **From Hard Rock: ~15 min walking**

□ **To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Green Park, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

Blue Bar at The Berkeley **///flame.fears.retail**

Sophisticated hotel cocktail bar in Knightsbridge, David Collins-designed interior

Wilton Pl, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7RL

□ **From Hard Rock: ~26 min walking**

□ **To The Melia: ~30 min - walk to Hyde Park Corner, Piccadilly line to Piccadilly Circus, change to Bakerloo, then ~5 min walk**

[Map](#)

[Website](#)

[TripAdvisor](#)

4 bars near The Melia:

The Lucky Pig

Speakeasy-style basement cocktail bar, just off Great Portland Street

5 Clipstone St, London W1W 6BB

▮ From The Melia: ~6 min walking

▮ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

The George, Fitzrovia

///moss.fend.agrees

Grade II listed 18th-century corner pub with an ornate Italianate facade

55 Great Portland St, London W1W 7LQ

▮ From The Melia: ~5 min walking

▮ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Artesian at The Langham

///nights.truly.squad

Multi-award-winning hotel cocktail bar - voted World's Best Bar for years running

1c Portland Pl, London W1B 1JA

▮ From The Melia: ~13 min walking

▮ To Hard Rock: ~20 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

Menu

TripAdvisor

The Social

Long-running Fitzrovia bar and music venue, intimate upstairs bar plus basement gigs/DJ sets

5 Little Portland St, London W1W 7JD

▮ From The Melia: ~9 min walking

▮ To Hard Rock: ~25 min - Bakerloo line from Regent's Park/Great Portland Street to Piccadilly Circus, change to Piccadilly line to Hyde Park Corner, then ~5 min walk

Map

Website

TripAdvisor

Sunday 27th September (Day 18)

AIR TRAVEL - DEPART LHR (T5) 10.00PM

📍 Sites within 20m

📍 Shops within 20m

8:00 AM - Breakfast at The Level
8:30 AM

7:00 PM Leave for Airport

10:00 PM Depart London Heathrow (T5) at 10.00pm - BA15 (British Airways) LHR (T5) to SIN (T1) PE, then BA15 SIN (T1) to SYD (T1) PE

Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

Option 1: Lunch at The Castle or The Sir John Oldcastle, Farringdon

Two pub options right by Farringdon station – a laid-back lunch stop before heading to the airport.

Getting there: Great Portland Street → Farringdon on the Metropolitan/Circle/Hammersmith & City line, direct (no change), ~6 min journey, then ~2-3 min walk from Farringdon station to either pub.

The Castle [///range.return.colleague](http://range.return.colleague)

Grade II listed pub & restaurant, est. 1865 – British pub food, craft beer, full bar, only pawnbroker's licence in London

34-35 Cowcross St, Farringdon, London EC1M 6DB

🕒 Sun 12pm-10:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)

📞 +44 20 7553 7621

Website

Menu

Map

I

The Sir John Oldcastle [///twin.milk.hurry](http://twin.milk.hurry)

JD Wetherspoon pub, named after the historical figure said to have inspired Shakespeare's Falstaff – British pub food, full bar, right next to Farringdon station

29-35 Farringdon Rd, Farringdon, London EC1M 3JF

🕒 Sun 8am-11:30pm (check ahead for any Sept 2026 changes)

📞 020 7242 1013

Website

Map

TripAdvisor

Things to Consider - London

Day	Item	Status	Notes
Thu (24)	Book airport transfer to hotel TO DO	TO BOOK	Arriving via BA575 from Milan (LIN-LHR), lands 2:50pm; transfer to The Level at Melia White House not yet booked
Sat (26)	Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour (combo) TO DO	TO CONFIRM	To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout (jennifer@inspire.headout.com) - see Links tab for tour detail from Deb
Sat (26)	Six the Musical tickets	BOOKED	Vaudeville Theatre, 4:00pm, Stalls G8-G11 (4 adults)
Sat (26)	Book dinner reservation - Hard Rock Cafe London TO DO	TO BOOK	150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ - cafe.hardrock.com/london - after the Six show (ends 5:15pm)
Sun (27)	Confirm transfer to airport TO DO	TO CONFIRM	Leaving hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm LHR departure

Within 20 Minutes of the Melia on foot

20 things to do within roughly a 20-minute walk of The Level at Meliá White House, Longford Street. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

The Regent's Park

Royal park right across the road - gardens, boating lake, rose garden (~1-2 min walk)

Chester Rd, London NW1 4NR

☎ 0300 061 2300

Map

London Zoo

World-famous zoo, inside Regent's Park (~15 min walk)

Outer Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4RY

☎ 0344 225 1826

Map

Regent's Park Open Air Theatre

Outdoor theatre - plays, concerts, events, seasonal (~15 min walk)

Inner Circle, Regent's Park, London NW1 4NU

☎ 0333 400 3562

Map

Sherlock Holmes Museum

Recreated Victorian rooms at the famous '221B' address (~10 min walk)

221b Baker St, London NW1 6XE

☎ 020 7224 3688

Map

Madame Tussauds London

Waxworks - celebrities, royals, film characters (~10 min walk)

Marylebone Rd, London NW1 5LR

☎ 0207 487 0350

Map

Baker Street

Iconic street, tube station, shops and cafes (~9 min walk)

Baker St, London NW1

Map

Marylebone High Street

Boutique shops, cafes and Daunt Books' famous store (~14 min walk)

Marylebone High St, London W1U

Map

The Wallace Collection

Free national museum - art, armour and furniture (~16 min walk)

Hertford House, Manchester Square, London W1U 3BN

☎ 020 7563 9500

Map

BBC Broadcasting House

Iconic Art Deco home of the BBC (~9 min walk)

Portland Pl, London W1A 1AA

☎ 0370 010 0222

Map

All Souls Church, Langham Place

Nash's striking circular church next to the BBC (~9 min walk)

2 All Souls Pl, London W1B 3DA

☎ 020 7580 3522

Map

RIBA (Royal Institute of British Architects)

Free exhibitions, cafe and bookshop (~8 min walk)

66 Portland Pl, London W1B 1AD

☎ +44 (0)20 7307 5355

Map

Great Portland Street shops & cafes

Right outside the hotel - cafes, restaurants, shops (~1-2 min walk)

Great Portland St, London W1W

Map

Charlotte Street, Fitzrovia

Buzzy strip of restaurants and bars (~15 min walk)

Charlotte St, London W1T

Map

Regent's Canal towpath

Scenic canal walk along the edge of Regent's Park (~12 min walk)

Regent's Canal, London NW1

Map

Euston Square & UCL area

University quarter with green squares (~10 min walk)

Euston Square Gardens, London NW1 2EF

Map

Wellcome Collection

Free museum exploring medicine, art and science (~10 min walk)

183 Euston Rd, London NW1 2BE

☎ 020 7611 2222

Map

London Central Mosque

Striking gold-domed mosque on the edge of Regent's Park (~14 min walk)

146 Park Rd, London NW8 7RG

☎ 020 7725 2152

Map

Cumberland Terrace

One of Regent's Park's grandest Nash terraces (~12 min walk)

Cumberland Terrace, London NW1 4HE

Map

Oxford Circus & top of Oxford Street

Flagship shopping - Regent Street meets Oxford Street (~17 min walk)

Oxford Circus, London W1B

Map

Primrose Hill

Park hill with panoramic skyline views over London (~19 min walk)

Primrose Hill, London NW1 4NR

Map

20 Shops to See in London

A top-20 pick of iconic London shops, department stores and markets – not all are near the hotel, so check travel time before heading out.

Harrods

Flagship luxury department store, iconic since 1834

87-135 Brompton Rd, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **+44 (0)20 7730 1234**

Map

Selfridges

Legendary Oxford Street department store

400 Oxford St, London W1A 1AB

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-10pm, Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7160 6222**

Map

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 1234**

Map

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☎ 020 7734 8040

Map

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☎ Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm

☎ 0371 704 1977

Map

John Lewis Oxford Street

Flagship department store

300 Oxford St, London W1C 1DX

☎ Mon-Wed & Fri-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Thu 9:30am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm

☎ 0345 608 0677

Map

Daunt Books Marylebone

Beautiful Edwardian travel bookshop

83 Marylebone High St, London W1U 4QW

☎ Mon-Sat 9am-7:30pm, Sun 11am-6pm

☎ 020 7224 2295

Map

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☎ Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm

☎ 020 7851 2400

Map

Burlington Arcade

Historic covered luxury shopping arcade

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7493 1764**

Map

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores

Regent St, London W1B

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

☐ **Varies by store**

Map

Camden Market

Alternative fashion, crafts and street food stalls

Camden Lock Pl, London NW1 8AF

☐ **Daily 10am-6pm (some stalls/evenings vary)**

☐ **020 3763 9999**

Map

Portobello Road Market

Antiques, vintage and fashion market

Portobello Rd, London W11 1LJ

☐ **Mon-Sat approx. 8am-7pm (Sat is main trading day)**

☐ **020 7727 7684**

Map

Borough Market

Historic food market

8 Southwark St, London SE1 1TL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-5pm (limited), Sat 8am-5pm, Sun 10am-3pm**

☐ **020 7407 1002**

Map

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, crafts market, street performers

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7395 3765**

Map

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more

New Bond St, London W1S

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

☐ **Varies by store**

Map

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7437 5660**

Map

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7025 7171**

Map

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7839 3480**

Map

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Primark Oxford Street

World's largest Primark store

14-28 Oxford St, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-10pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7580 5510**

[Map](#)

20 Shops within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 shops, arcades and shopping streets all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Fortnum & Mason

Royal grocer since 1707 - hampers, tea, food halls (~2 min walk)

181 Piccadilly, London W1A 1ER

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 8040**

[Map](#)

Hatchards

UK's oldest bookshop (est. 1797), five floors, right next to Fortnum's (~2 min walk)

187 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LE

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-8pm, Sun 10:30am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Waterstones Piccadilly

Europe's largest bookshop (~3 min walk)

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☐ **Mon-Sat 9am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6:30pm**

☐ **020 7851 2400**

[Map](#)

Burlington Arcade

Historic 1819 covered luxury shopping arcade with uniformed Beadles (~4 min walk)

51 Piccadilly, London W1J 0QJ

☐ **Mon-Sat 8am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

☐ **020 7493 1764**

[Map](#)

Penhaligon's

British perfumer established 1870, inside Burlington Arcade (~4 min walk)

16-17 Burlington Arcade, London W1J 0PL

☐ **Check ahead - hours vary**

☐ **020 7629 1416**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Prince's Arcade

Victorian shopping arcade linking Piccadilly to Jermyn Street (~4 min walk)

8-10 Prince's Arcade, Piccadilly, London SW1Y 6DS

☐ **Varies by store**

[Map](#)

Lillywhites

Flagship five-floor sports store, oldest in the UK (est. 1863), right on Piccadilly Circus (~1 min walk)

24-36 Regent St, London SW1Y 4QF

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0844 332 5602**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Hamleys

World's oldest and largest toy shop (~7 min walk)

188-196 Regent St, London W1B 5BT

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **0371 704 1977**

[Map](#)

Apple Store Regent Street

Flagship Apple store in a historic building (~9 min walk)

235 Regent St, London W1B 2EL

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-9pm, Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 10am-6pm**

☐ **020 7153 9000**

[Map](#)

Liberty London

Tudor-revival department store, famous for its prints (~8 min walk)

Great Marlborough St, London W1B 5AH

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7734 1234**

[Map](#)

Regent Street

Iconic curved shopping street, flagship stores end to end (~1-9 min walk)

Regent St, London W1B

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7/8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

[Map](#)

Carnaby Street

Swinging-60s fashion street, now independent boutiques and big brands (~8 min walk)

Carnaby St, London W1F

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-7pm, Sun 12-6pm)**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Jermyn Street

London's shirtmaking street - Turnbull & Asser and other historic tailors (~5 min walk)

71-72 Jermyn St, London SW1Y 6PF

☐ **Mon-Fri 9am-6pm, Sat 9:30am-6pm (closed Sun)**

☐ **020 7808 3000**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Savile Row

The world-famous bespoke tailoring street (~10 min walk)

32 Old Burlington St / 17 Clifford St, London W1S

☐ **Mon-Fri 8:30am-5pm (haberdashery also open Sat 10:30am-4pm)**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

M&M's World

Multi-storey confectionery flagship store, Leicester Square (~6 min walk)

1 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-9pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7025 7171**

[Map](#)

LEGO Store Leicester Square

Flagship LEGO store (~6 min walk)

3 Swiss Ct, London W1D 6AP

☐ **Mon-Sat 10am-10pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7839 3480**

[Map](#)

Foyles Charing Cross Road

Famous independent bookshop, five floors (~9 min walk)

107 Charing Cross Rd, London WC2H 0DT

☐ **Mon-Sat 9:30am-9pm, Sun 11:30am-6pm**

☐ **020 7437 5660**

[Map](#)

Covent Garden Market

Boutiques, craft market, street performers (~10 min walk)

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

☐ **Mon-Fri 10am-8pm, Sat 9am-8pm, Sun 12pm-6pm**

☐ **020 7395 3765**

[Map](#)

New Bond Street

Luxury flagship boutiques - Chanel, Tiffany & more (~10 min walk)

New Bond St, London W1S

☐ **Varies by store (most 10am-6/7pm, Sun 12pm-6pm)**

[Map](#)

St James's Market

Small modern food-and-shopping precinct behind Waterstones (~4 min walk)

St James's Market, London SW1Y 4AH

☐ **Varies by outlet**

[Map](#)

20 Things to Do within 15 Minutes of Piccadilly Circus

20 sights, galleries, parks and landmarks all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus tube station. Walk times are estimates – check live maps nearer the time.

Piccadilly Circus & the Shaftesbury Memorial (Eros)

[///tidy.loyal.public](#)

The famous statue and video-screen hub itself - starting point for everything below

Piccadilly Circus, London W1J

[Map](#)

St James's Church Piccadilly

Wren-designed church (1684) with a leafy courtyard and craft/antiques market most days

197 Piccadilly, London W1J 9LL

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Royal Academy of Arts

Major art exhibitions inside historic Burlington House - free courtyard and permanent collection displays

Burlington House, Piccadilly, London W1J 0BD

🕒 **Tue-Thu & Sun 10am-6pm, Fri-Sat 10am-9pm (closed Mon)**

📞 **020 7300 8090**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Leicester Square

Cinemas, half-price theatre ticket booth (TKTS) and street entertainers

Leicester Square, London WC2H 7NA

[Map](#)

Chinatown London

Pagoda gates, dim sum and Chinese bakeries around Gerrard Street

Gerrard St, London W1D 5PW

[Map](#)

Soho Square

Small leafy square in the heart of Soho, good for a sit-down break

Soho Square, London W1D 3QP

[Map](#)

Trafalgar Square

Nelson's Column, the four bronze lions and the famous fourth plinth artwork

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

[Map](#)

National Gallery

World-class collection of Western European paintings - free entry to the permanent collection

Trafalgar Square, London WC2N 5DN

🕒 **Daily 10am-6pm, Fri until 9pm**

[Website](#)[Map](#)

National Portrait Gallery

Portraits of famous Britons through history - free entry to the permanent collection

St Martin's Place, London WC2H 0HE

🕒 **Daily 10:30am-6pm, Fri-Sat until 9pm**

[Website](#)[Map](#)

St James's Park

One of London's prettiest royal parks - lake, pelicans, views to Buckingham Palace

St James's Park, London SW1A 2BJ

[Map](#)

Green Park

Quiet, tree-lined royal park between Piccadilly and Buckingham Palace

Green Park, London SW1A 1BW

[Map](#)

The Ritz London

Legendary 1906 hotel - iconic Louis XVI-style facade, famous afternoon tea (book well ahead)

150 Piccadilly, London W1J 9BR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Spencer House

Princess Diana's ancestral family home - 18th-century state rooms, open select days

27 St James's Place, London SW1A 1NR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Christie's

World-famous auction house - free public viewing rooms before major sales

8 King St, St James's, London SW1Y 6QT

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Handel & Hendrix House

Composer Handel's Georgian home next door to where Jimi Hendrix once lived - small museum

25 Brook St, London W1K 4HB

☐ **Wed-Sun 10am-5pm (closed Mon-Tue)**

☐ **020 7495 1685**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

The Photographers' Gallery

London's leading photography gallery - free exhibitions on the ground floor

16-18 Ramillies St, London W1F 7LW

☐ **Mon-Wed & Sat 10:30am-6pm, Thu-Fri 10:30am-8pm, Sun 11am-6pm**

[Website](#)

[Map](#)

Covent Garden Piazza

Street performers, market stalls and the Royal Opera House

The Piazza, Covent Garden, London WC2E 8RF

[Map](#)

Shaftesbury Avenue Theatreland

London's main theatre strip - Lyric, Apollo, Gielgud, Queen's and more, all in a row

Shaftesbury Ave, London W1D

[Map](#)

Waterloo Place & Duke of York Column

Grand statue-lined avenue with steps down toward The Mall and St James's Park

Waterloo Place, London SW1Y 5AY

[Map](#)

Berkeley Square

Mayfair's grand garden square, lined with plane trees - of 'nightingale sang' fame

Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

Cars Baby Cars

Supercar and luxury-marque showrooms clustered around Berkeley Square, Mayfair – all within roughly a 15-minute walk of Piccadilly Circus.

Rolls-Royce Motor Cars London

Flagship Rolls-Royce showroom on the corner of Berkeley Street and Stratton Street (~10 min walk)

50 Berkeley St, London W1J 8HD

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Jack Barclay Bentley

London's oldest Bentley dealership (since 1927), on Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

18 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6AE

[Website](#)[Map](#)

H.R. Owen Ferrari Mayfair

Official Ferrari flagship showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

15-17 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6EG

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Lamborghini Mayfair

H.R. Owen flagship Lamborghini showroom, Berkeley Square (~10 min walk)

20 Berkeley Square, London W1J 6BR

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Volvo Cars Central London

Official Volvo showroom and service centre, Swiss Cottage (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

1 Northways Parade, Finchley Rd, London NW3 5EN

[Website](#)[Map](#)

Mercedes-Benz of Chelsea

Official Mercedes-Benz showroom on Wandsworth Bridge (a drive/tube ride, not walkable)

Jews Row, Wandsworth, London SW18 1TB

[Website](#)[Map](#)

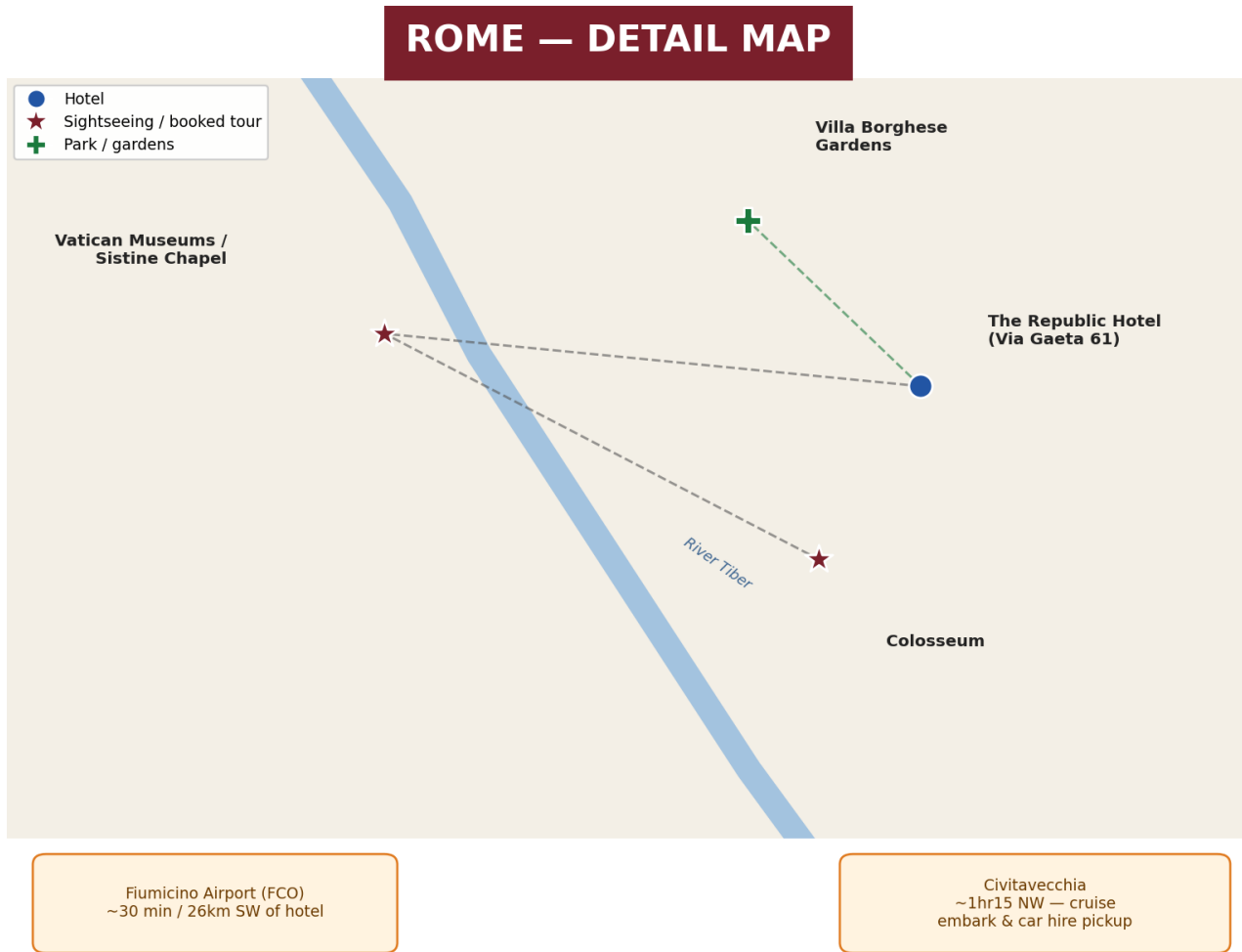
Rolls-Royce, Bentley, Ferrari and Lamborghini are all genuinely walkable from Piccadilly Circus around Berkeley Square, Mayfair. Volvo and Mercedes-Benz are London dealerships but sit further out (Swiss Cottage and Wandsworth) - worth a taxi/tube rather than a walk. Zeekr doesn't have a UK showroom yet - its London launch is expected later in 2026.

Places & Maps

Schematic maps and place lists from the itinerary, with website and review links.

'I' buttons link to that place's official Instagram page.

Rome



Schematic map (not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel (11-14 Sep)

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Fiumicino Airport (FCO)

Airport - arrival

Fiumicino Airport, Rome

Map

I

Vatican Museums / Sistine Chapel

Sightseeing - booked (Sat 12 Sep, 7:15am, 4hrs)

Vatican Museums, Vatican City

Map

I

Villa Borghese Gardens

Sightseeing (Fri 11 Sep, 3-5pm)

Villa Borghese, Rome, Italy

Map

Colosseum

Sightseeing - booked (Sun 13 Sep, 3:30pm, 3.5hrs, Arena Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace)

Piazza del Colosseo, 1, 00184 Roma RM, Italy

Map

I

Civitavecchia

Cruise embark / car hire (Mon 14 & Mon 21 Sep)

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Cantina Cantarini da Mario

Restaurant candidate - veal scaloppine al limone (Tripadvisor 3.9/5)

Piazza Sallustio 24, 00187 Roma

Menu

Map

Reviews

I

Girarrosto Fiorentino

Restaurant candidate - veal specialties (Google 4.4/5)

Via Sicilia 46, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Colline Emiliane

Restaurant candidate - veal specialties (Tripadvisor 4.5/5)

Via degli Avignonesi 22, 00187 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

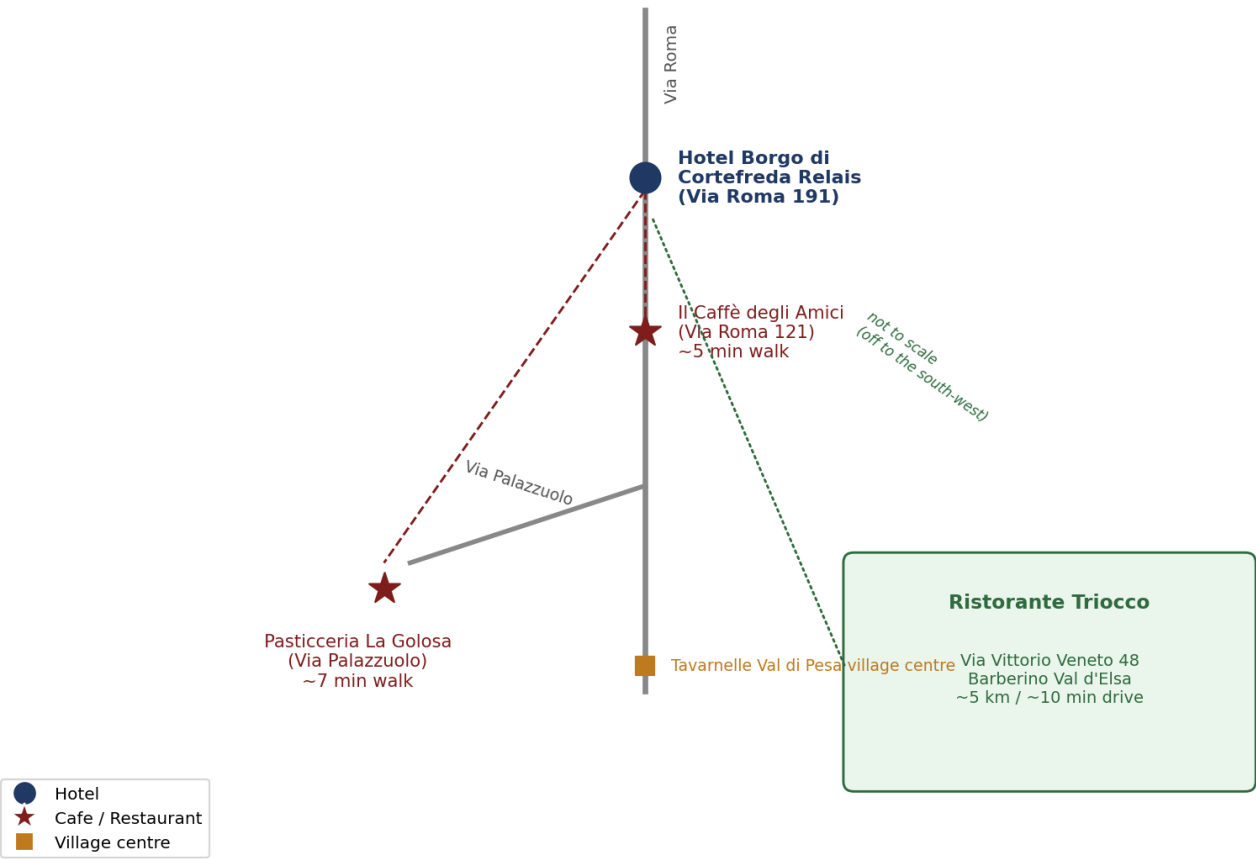
Trattoria Monti

Restaurant candidate - classic Marche/Roman cuisine (top ~4% of Rome restaurants)

Via di San Vito 13/a, 00185 Roma

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)

Tavarnelle Val di Pesa — Hotel Area



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel (14-16 Sep)

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu Map Reviews I

Pasticceria La Golosa

Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Map

Reviews

Ristorante Triocco

Dinner option - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.6/5, 334 reviews, #2 of 20 in Barberino Val d'Elsa)

Via Vittorio Veneto 48, 50021 Barberino Val d'Elsa, Barberino Tavarnelle

Menu

Map

Reviews

I

Agriturismo Buratta

Lunch option - potential stop en route from Civitavecchia (Tripadvisor 4.0/5, 832 reviews, #1 of 19 in Talamone)

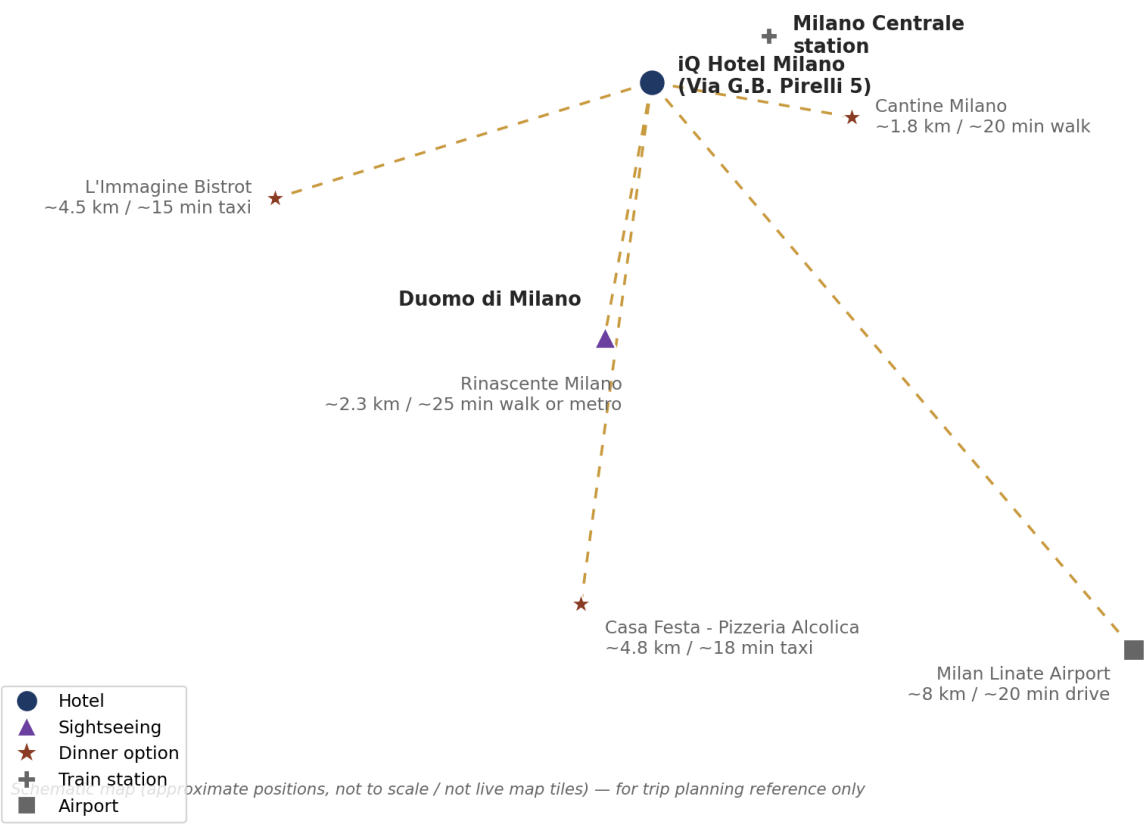
Strada Vicinale delle Casacce, 65, 58010 Talamone, Orbetello

Menu

Map

Reviews

Milan — Detail Map



Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

iQ Hotel Milano

Hotel

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli, 5, 20124 Milan

Map

I

Milan Linate Airport

Airport (car return)

Milan Linate Airport

Map

I

Rinascente Milano

Department store / Shopping

Map

I

Fornasetti (flagship store)

Potential shop - official Fornasetti flagship, iconic Italian design house (~3.5 km / ~45 min walk from hotel, or ~10-15 min by taxi/metro)

Via Senato 2, 20121 Milan (near Corso Venezia)

🕒 10:00am-7:30pm (confirm exact days, especially Sundays)

Website

Map

I

Italy Overview (cruise ports & drive route)

ITALY — TRIP MAP



Schematic map (approximate positions, not to scale / not live map tiles) — for trip planning reference only

Schematic map – approximate positions, not to scale

The Republic Hotel

Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 185 Rome

Map

Civitavecchia (cruise embark / car hire)

Port / Car hire

Via 16 Settembre 46, Civitavecchia

Map

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Hotel

Via Roma 191, 50028, Tavarnelle Val Di Pesa

Map

I

Marseille, France

Cruise port of call

Marseille, France

Map

I

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Cruise port of call

Villefranche-sur-Mer, France

Map

I

Genoa, Italy

Cruise port of call

Genoa, Italy

Map

I

La Spezia, Italy

Cruise port of call

La Spezia, Italy

Map

I

Il Caffè degli Amici

Cafe/restaurant - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.7/5, 562 reviews)

Via Roma 121, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Menu

Map

I

Pasticceria La Golosa

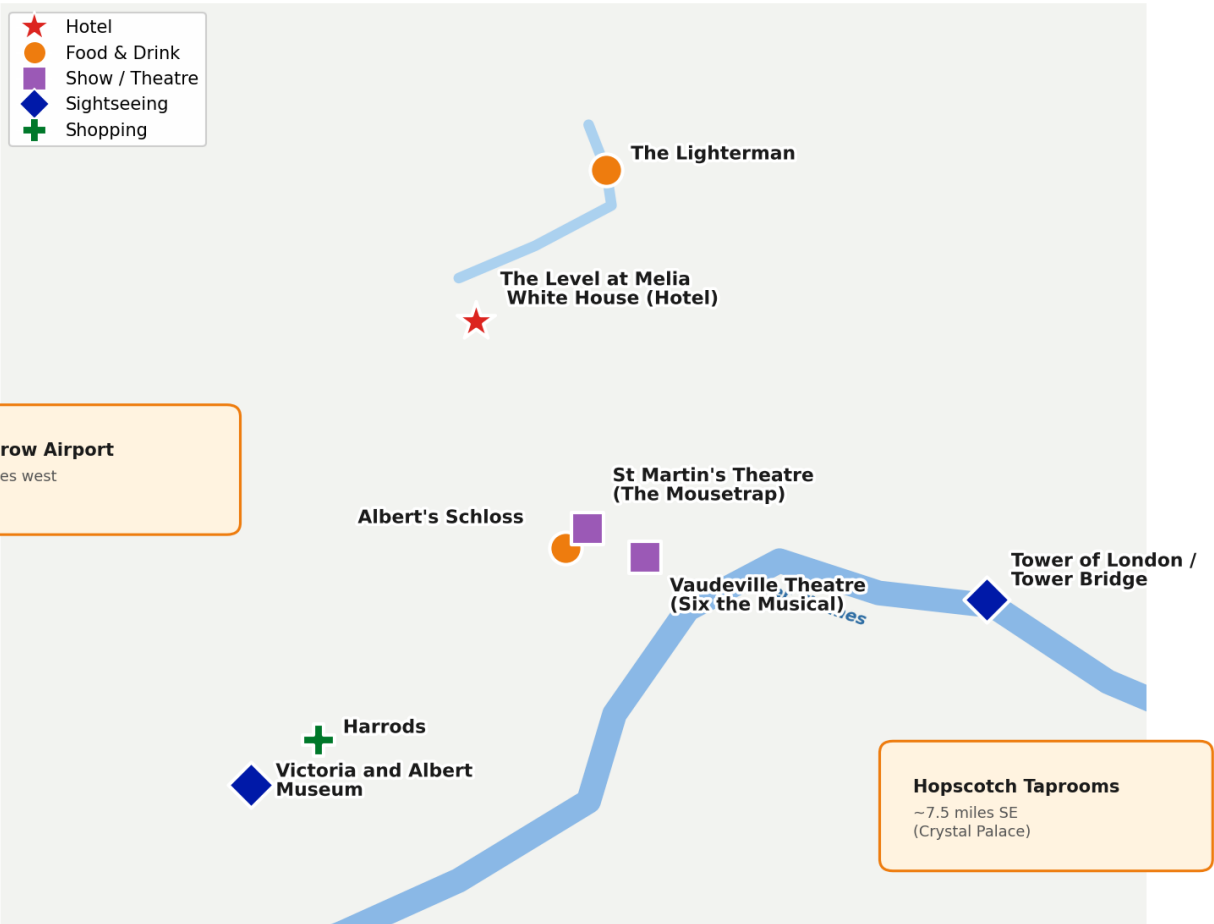
Pastry shop/cafe - potential place to go (Tripadvisor 4.4/5, 31 reviews)

Via Palazzuolo, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa

Map

LONDON — TRIP MAP

Central London



Schematic diagram (not to scale, in the style of a transit map) - use the Google Maps links in the sheet for turn-by-turn directions.

Schematic map - approximate positions, not to scale

The Level at Melia White House

Hotel - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km) to Great Portland Street Underground station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines), directly opposite the hotel

Longford Street, Regents Park, London NW1 3UP

Website

Map

I

Heathrow Airport

Travel / Airport

Heathrow Airport, Hounslow TW6 1EW

☎ 0344 335 1801

[Map](#)[I](#)

Albert's Schloss

Food & Drink

20-24 Shaftesbury Avenue, London W1D 7EU

☎ 020 8165 0000

✉ eventslondon@albertsschloss.co.uk

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

The Lighterman

Food & Drink

3 Granary Square, London N1C 4BH

☎ 020 3846 3400

[Menu](#)[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

St Martin's Theatre (The Mousetrap)

Show / Theatre

West Street, London WC2H 9NZ

☎ 020 7836 1443

[Map](#)

Vaudeville Theatre (Six the Musical)

Show / Theatre

404 Strand, London WC2R 0NH

☎ 0330 333 4814

✉ boxoffice@nimaxtheatres.com

[Map](#)[I](#)

Tower of London / Tower Bridge

Sightseeing

Tower of London, EC3N 4AB

☎ 020 3166 6646

[Map](#)[Reviews](#)[I](#)

Hopscotch Taprooms

Food & Drink

54 Westow Hill, London SE19 1RX

☎ +44 7394 072189

Website

Menu

Map

I

Harrods

Shopping

87-135 Brompton Road, Knightsbridge, London SW1X 7XL

☎ +44 (0)20 7730 1234

Map

I

Victoria and Albert Museum

Sightseeing

Cromwell Road, London SW7 2RL

☎ 020 7942 2000

Map

I

Harry's Knightsbridge

Food & Drink

27-31 Basil Street, Knightsbridge, London SW3 1BB

☎ +44 20 3940 1020

Website

Menu

Map

Reviews

Primark (Oxford Street)

Shopping

14-28 Oxford Street, Fitzrovia, London W1D 1AU

☎ 020 7580 5510

Map

I

Uniqlo (Oxford Street)

Shopping

311 Oxford Street, London W1C 2HP

Map

I

Waterstones Piccadilly (for Karen)

Shopping - Books

203-206 Piccadilly, London W1J 9HD

☎ 020 7851 2400

Map

I

Oxford Street

Shopping street

Oxford Street, London W1

Website

Map

I

Things to Do

Everything still to book or confirm, pulled together from across the itinerary.

Date	Item	Status	Notes	Book
Sat 12 Sep	Book Vatican Necropolis (Scavi Tour) - Tomb of St Peter /// searched.circling.supposed	TO BOOK	Guided tour beneath St Peter's Basilica ending at the tomb believed to hold St Peter's remains - must be booked well in advance (small groups, no photos allowed). Slotted into Saturday afternoon (after the Pristine Sistine tour and lunch) as one of the free-afternoon options. Book ahead - popular, limited daily slots.	
Sat 12 Sep	Dinner reservation - Rome (Veal Scaloppine al limone)	TO CONFIRM	Choose from: Cantina Cantarini da Mario, Girarrosto Fiorentino, Colline Emiliane, Trattoria Monti - see Rome Map tab Decide on the day.	
Mon 14 Sep	Confirm transfer time to Queen Victoria	TO CONFIRM	Transfer by private minibus, Rome to Civitavecchia - likely mid-afternoon, evening departure. Gary checked with Lynnaire on 30 July, awaiting a response.	
Thu 24 Sep	Book airport transfer to hotel	TO BOOK	Arriving via BA0575 from Milan (LIN-LHR); transfer to The Level at Melia White House Gary checked on 30 July - ongoing, to monitor.	
Sat 26 Sep	Confirm Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour (combo)	TO CONFIRM	To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout (jennifer@inspire.headout.com)	

Sat 26 Sep	Dinner reservation - Hard Rock Cafe London	TO BOOK	150 Old Park Lane, Mayfair, London W1K 1QZ - after the Six show (ends 5:15pm)
Sun 27 Sep	Confirm transfer to airport	TO CONFIRM	Leaving hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm LHR departure
Fri 11 Sep	Confirm booking reference for Fiumicino to hotel transfer	TO CONFIRM	Private minibus, Fiumicino Airport to The Republic Hotel (Via Gaeta 61, Rome) - arranged in principle but no booking or confirmation reference is on file
Fri 11 Sep	Dinner reservation - Rome	TO BOOK	No table booked yet - choose from the 8 Dinner Suggestions on the Rome page (within ~20 min walk of The Republic Hotel) Decide on the day.
Sun 13 Sep	Dinner reservation - Rome (near the Colosseum)	TO BOOK	No table booked yet - Colosseum tour finishes ~7pm; choose from the 8 Dinner Suggestions on the Rome page near Piazza del Colosseo Decide on the day.
Mon 21 Sep	Dinner reservation - Tuscany	TO BOOK	No dinner plan yet for the first night at Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais - hotel restaurant or a short drive into Tavarnelle Val di Pesa
Tue 22 Sep	Dinner reservation - Tuscany (Triocco)	TO CONFIRM	Triocco, Barberino Val d'Elsa pencilled in as a potential 7pm dinner spot - not yet booked
Wed 23 Sep	Dinner reservation - Milan	TO BOOK	No table booked yet - choose from the 8 dinner options on the Milan page (7:00-8:30pm, before LiQuido Rooftop Bar nightcap)

Things to Take

Packing checklist. Tick boxes save in this browser only — they don't sync back to the spreadsheet, so keep the master list on the Things to Do tab in the workbook up to date separately.

Item	Packed?
Euro Power Adapter	☐
Passports with 6 months left	☐
Check on VPN support	☐
Hats for us all (for tours)	☐
Water (for tours)	☐
DJI Gimbal (Gary)	☐
Get some Pounds and some Euro's for OOPE	☐

☐ UK ETA Applications - tick off once each person has applied

Apply here: gov.uk/eta/apply - each of the 4 of us needs our own UK ETA before flying to London. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Applied?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Debbie Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

☐ Passport Validity Check - tick off once each passport is confirmed valid

Passports need at least 6 months' validity remaining AT THE END of the trip (29 Sept 2026) - so valid until at least 29 March 2027. Tick boxes save in this browser only.

Name	Checked?
Karen Nicholson	☐
Debbie Gyde	☐
Thomas Akhurst	☐
Gary Nicholson	☐

Hotel Addresses

Every hotel on the trip, with address, phone and email – use Print for a paper copy or a browser "Save as PDF", or Email to send yourself/family a copy.

The Republic Hotel

Via Gaeta 61, 00185 Rome, Italy

☐ **11-14 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 14th for Civitavecchia/cruise embarkation)**

☐ **+39 06 8115 7001**

✉ **therepublic@aghotels.it**

Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais

Via Roma 191, 50028 Tavarnelle Val di Pesa (FI), Italy

☐ **21-23 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 23rd for the drive to Milan)**

☐ **+39 055 807 3333**

✉ **info@borgodicortefreda.com**

iQ Hotel Milano

Via Giovanni Battista Pirelli 5, 20124 Milan, Italy

☐ **23-24 Sept 2026 (check-out morning of the 24th for the flight to London)**

☐ **+39 02 8498 0810**

✉ **info@iqhotelmilano.it**

The Level at Melia White House

Longford Street, Regent's Park, London NW1 3UP, United Kingdom

☐ **24-27 Sept 2026 (depart Heathrow the night of the 27th)**

☐ **+44 20 7391 3000**

✉ **melia.white.house@melia.com**

☐ **Great Portland Street station (Circle, Hammersmith & City, Metropolitan lines) - approx. 2-3 min walk (~0.2 km), directly opposite the hotel**

London Tube Map

The official TfL Tube map, saved here so it's always at hand even offline.

 [CLICK HERE to view the Tube Map \(PDF\)](#)

Fun Facts by Day

Extra fun facts for the places we're seeing each day – on top of the ones shown in each day's Fun Facts box on screen.

Friday 11th September (Day 2)

Tucked inside Villa Borghese is a curious 1867 water clock, invented by the monk-scientist Giovan Battista Embriaco, which still keeps time today using only the flow and pressure of water – no electricity or batteries. — [Turismo Roma](#)

Cardinal Scipione Borghese amassed a private collection of over 800 sculptures and paintings by artists including Caravaggio, Bernini and Titian, which only became the public Galleria Borghese museum after the Italian state bought the estate from the family in 1902. — [Wikipedia](#)

Saturday 12th September (Day 3)

A ten-year restoration of the Sistine Chapel ceiling, completed in 1990 and sponsored by Japan's Nippon Television, stripped away centuries of soot, glue and candle grease to reveal Michelangelo's original vivid colours hidden underneath. — [Wikipedia](#)

Michelangelo became chief architect of St Peter's Basilica in 1547 at the age of 71, but only lived to see the drum of its dome completed; his design was finished by Giacomo della Porta and Domenico Fontana in 1590, 26 years after his death. — [Wikipedia](#)

Sunday 13th September (Day 4)

The Colosseum's opening games in 80 AD reportedly included a naumachia, a staged naval battle, with the arena flooded for small ships – once the underground hypogeum was built under Emperor Domitian, further flooding became impossible and the practice stopped. — [Wikipedia](#)

The amphitheatre wasn't officially called the Colosseum in ancient times – it was the Flavian Amphitheatre – and the popular name actually comes from the Colossus of Nero, a giant bronze statue over 30 metres tall that once stood beside it. — [Wikipedia](#)

Monday 14th September (Day 5)

Civitavecchia's harbour fortress, Forte Michelangelo, was designed by the architect Bramante in 1508 and completed in 1537 under the supervision of Michelangelo himself, and it still stands guard over the port today. — [Port of Rome - Civitavecchia](#)

In 1696, Pope Innocent XII declared Civitavecchia a free port, exempting trading ships from certain taxes – a status that helped it grow into Rome's principal seaport. — [Britannica](#)

Tuesday 15th September (Day 6)

Queen Victoria was christened in Southampton on 10 December 2007 by Camilla, Duchess of Cornwall, and set sail on her maiden voyage to the Canary Islands the very next day.

— [Wikipedia](#)

The custom of afternoon tea dates back to the 1840s, credited to Anna, 7th Duchess of Bedford, who began taking tea and a light snack in her rooms to bridge the gap between lunch and dinner – a habit Queen Victoria herself later helped make fashionable. — [British Museum](#)

Wednesday 16th September (Day 7)

Marseille's signature bouillabaisse traces back to a simple fisherman's stew the ancient Greeks called kakavia; in 1980 the city's restaurateurs even drew up an official Bouillabaisse Charter defining the authentic recipe and ingredients. — [National Geographic](#)

Marseille's Vieux Port was once spanned by a pioneering transporter bridge, inaugurated in 1905, which carried passengers and vehicles across the harbour entrance on a suspended gondola until German forces destroyed it in 1944. — [Wikipedia](#)

Thursday 17th September (Day 8)

In 1297, the Grimaldi family seized Monaco's fortress when François Grimaldi disguised himself as a Franciscan monk to sneak armed men inside – the origin of the sword-wielding monk still shown on Monaco's coat of arms today. — [Wikipedia](#)

Prince Rainier III's 1956 marriage to Hollywood actress Grace Kelly at Monaco's Saint Nicholas Cathedral was watched by more than 30 million television viewers worldwide, dubbed the 'wedding of the century'. — [History.com](#)

Friday 18th September (Day 9)

The word "jeans" traces back to Genoa itself: French traders called the sturdy cotton fabric woven there for sailors' trousers "bleu de Gênes" (blue of Genoa), later shortened to "jean". — [Merriam-Webster](#)

From the 11th century until Napoleon dissolved it in 1797, Genoa was the seat of its own maritime superpower, the Republic of Genoa, whose fleets and banks once rivalled Venice's. — [Wikipedia](#)

Saturday 19th September (Day 10)

The tower was already sinking before it even looked crooked: by the time builders reached the second floor in 1178, the soft subsoil beneath its shallow 3-metre foundation had begun to give way, decades before the famous lean became obvious. — [Wikipedia](#)

Legend says Galileo Galilei, who lived in Pisa, dropped two cannonballs of different masses from the tower around 1589-92 to prove they fall at the same speed – but the only source is a biography written by his student decades later, and historians still dispute whether it happened. — [Wikipedia](#)

Sunday 20th September (Day 11)

Queen Victoria was the first Cunard ship to feature West End-style private theatre boxes, in her three-storey Royal Court Theatre – an innovation later copied on sister ship Queen Elizabeth. — [Cunard](#)

Each year, guests and crew aboard Queen Victoria get through around 1.5 million fresh eggs and close to a million cups of tea. — [Cunard](#)

Monday 21st September (Day 12)

Talamone's Etruscan temple, built in the 4th century BC to honour the god Tinia, once bore a dramatic terracotta pediment depicting the myth of the "Seven Against Thebes"; the surviving reliefs are now housed in Florence's Archaeological Museum. — [In Vacanza all'Argentario](#)

San Gimignano grew rich on saffron: medieval merchants exported its "red gold" as far as Alexandria and Damietta, and the profits helped fund the stone tower-houses that still define the skyline. — [Visit Tuscany](#)

Tuesday 22nd September (Day 13)

The name "Chianti" first appears in writing as early as 1398, in a notarial document referring to wine from the area – centuries before the modern Chianti Classico appellation existed. — [Consorzio Vino Chianti Classico](#)

In 1716, Grand Duke Cosimo III de' Medici issued a decree formally defining the boundaries of the Chianti wine-producing zone, making it one of the earliest legally delimited wine regions in the world. — [Consorzio Vino Chianti Classico](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14)

The golden Madonnina statue atop Milan's Duomo secretly doubles as a giant lightning rod – the metal halberd she holds was engineered to protect the cathedral from lightning strikes. — [Duomo di Milano](#)

From 1939, Milan's golden Madonnina was covered in grey-green camouflage cloth for five years during the Second World War, so Allied bombers couldn't use her golden glint to pinpoint the city. — [Duomo di Milano](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option A - Lake Como & Harry's Bar

The Roman writer Pliny the Younger owned two villas on Lake Como which he nicknamed "Comedy" and "Tragedy" – one perched high with sweeping views, the other so close to the water he claimed he could fish from his bedroom window. — [Wikipedia](#)

Julius Caesar conquered the Como area in 49 BC and resettled it with 5,000 colonists, founding "Novum Comum"; the Romans named the lake itself "Larius", the root of its modern name, Como. — [Lake Como Tours](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option B - Ferrari Maranello

The Ferrari Museum in Maranello opened on 18 February 1990 – deliberately chosen as the birthday of founder Enzo Ferrari, known as "the Drake", who had died two years earlier in 1988. — [VisitModena](#)

Enzo Ferrari personally test-drove every car his factory produced, but for his own daily journeys he had a soft spot for four-seaters – a preference that ran from the 1960 250 GT 2+2 to the 456 GT he approved in 1988. — [Ferrari.com](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option C - Venice

The Republic of Venice was an independent maritime power for more than 1,100 years, from 697 AD until Napoleon deposed the last doge, Ludovico Manin, in 1797. — [World History Encyclopedia](#)

The enclosed Bridge of Sighs, built around 1600, connects the Doge's Palace interrogation rooms to the old prisons; its name comes from the sighs of condemned prisoners glimpsing their last view of Venice through its stone-barred windows. — [Britannica](#)

Wednesday 23rd September (Day 14) - Option D - Pisa & Lake Como

The Leaning Tower took almost 200 years to finish because a war between Pisa and Genoa halted construction for nearly a century after only three storeys had been built – the accidental pause let the soft subsoil settle and likely stopped the tower toppling over. — [History.com](#)

Lake Como's grand lakeside villas have drawn the wealthy since Roman times; actor George Clooney bought the 18th-century Villa Oleandra in the village of Laglio in 2002, joining a long line of noble and celebrity residents on its shores. — [Live The World](#)

Thursday 24th September (Day 15)

Regent's Canal, which runs past The Lighterman, was designed by architect John Nash – the same man behind Regent Street, Regent's Park and Buckingham Palace – and opened to great fanfare in 1820. — [King's Cross](#)

Granary Square, where The Lighterman sits, was once a Victorian canal basin where barges unloaded wheat for London's bakers; today the same spot features over 1,000 individually choreographed fountains. — [King's Cross](#)

Friday 25th September (Day 16)

The Mousetrap began life as a short BBC radio play called 'Three Blind Mice', which Agatha Christie wrote as an 80th-birthday gift for Queen Mary in 1947, before she expanded it into the stage play in 1952. — [Agatha Christie](#)

The V&A's National Art Library holds more than 750,000 books, photographs and drawings, including works connected to Leonardo da Vinci's notebooks. — [Victoria and Albert Museum](#)

Saturday 26th September (Day 17)

Hard Rock Cafe's now-famous memorabilia collection began right there in London in 1979, when regular customer Eric Clapton gave the cafe a signed Fender guitar; the venue today also houses 'The Vault', London's only rock-and-roll museum. — [Hard Rock International](#)

Six the Musical's writers modelled each of Henry VIII's wives on a real pop star – Catherine of Aragon channels Beyoncé, Anne Boleyn is Avril Lavigne/Lily Allen, Jane Seymour is Adele, Anne of Cleves is Nicki Minaj/Rihanna, and Katherine Howard is Ariana Grande/Britney Spears. — [BBC Newsbeat](#)

Sunday 27th September (Day 18)

Heathrow handled just 63,000 passengers in its first full year of operation in 1946; by 2025 that figure had grown to a record 84.5 million passengers in a single year. — [Aerospace Global News](#)

The Castle's current building on Cowcross Street, Farringdon, is Grade II listed and dates to 1865, sitting just off historic Smithfield Market in the City of London's square mile. — [CAMRA](#)